

Lab 3.1: Draft an Account Plan and QBR Agenda

Introduction

In this lab, you will practice applying account management and customer success principles to a real-world customer scenario. You will document customer objectives, initiatives, and success metrics using an account plan, then translate that information into a structured Quarterly Business Review (QBR) agenda.

The goal is not perfection; it is learning how to think strategically about an existing customer relationship and create value-driven touchpoints.

Learning Objectives

By the end of this lab, you will be able to:

- Translate customer business context into documented objectives, initiatives, and success metrics.
- Identify stakeholder roles and relationship depth in an existing account.



- Create an account plan that connects customer goals to delivered value.
- Structure a QBR agenda as a value conversation, not a status meeting.
- Allocate time effectively across QBR sections to maximize strategic impact.



Scenario

Your Company: ProClean Commercial Services

Customer Account: TechStart Inc.

Customer Profile

Industry: Software development (B2B SaaS for HR tech)

Size: 100 employees (grew from 75 in the past 6 months)

Office space: 15,000 square feet (single floor, open plan + 8 conference rooms)

Relationship duration: Current ProClean client for 6 months

Services: Daily office cleaning, weekly deep-clean for conference rooms, monthly carpet and window cleaning

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Business Context

TechStart recently raised Series B funding (\$15 million) and is hiring aggressively.

They host frequent client demos and investor meetings in their office.

Office appearance and professionalism matter to client impressions.

CFO (Sarah Chen) is cost-conscious but values reliability.

Office Manager (Marcus Thompson) handles day-to-day facilities but reports issues to leadership.

CEO (James Rivera) mentioned "professional workspace" as a company value during onboarding.

Recent Developments

Month 3: Minor complaints about conference room cleaning schedule conflicting with early meetings.

Month 4: Positive feedback from the CEO after an investor meeting about office appearance.

Month 5: Request to add a bi-weekly kitchen deep-clean (expansion opportunity).

Month 6: Marcus mentioned they are evaluating "vendor reliability" across all service contracts.

Your Role:

You are the ProClean Account Manager for TechStart. It is time to prepare for your first Quarterly Business Review (QBR) with the account. You need to create an account plan and QBR agenda that demonstrates value and reinforces the partnership.

Activity Steps

Exercise 1: Draft a Basic Account Plan

Step 1: Review the account plan template

Familiarize yourself with the template sections:

- Account Overview (basic facts)

- Customer Objectives (what success looks like for them)

- Key Customer Initiatives (active projects or priorities)

- Success Metrics (how progress is measured)

- Stakeholder Map (who matters in this relationship)

- Current Value Delivered (what youve done for them)

- Risks or Watchouts (potential issues)

- Next Steps (what to do next)

Step 2: Complete key sections for TechStart

Based on the scenario, fill in:

- Account Overview: Basic facts about TechStart.

- Customer Objectives: What does TechStart care about?
(Hint: professional image, reliability, and growth support.)

- Key Initiatives: What are they actively working on? (Hint: hiring, client acquisition, or Series B execution.)

Success Metrics: How would you measure success from their perspective? (Hint: client feedback, zero complaints, or schedule consistency.)

Stakeholder Map: Who are the key contacts? What role does each play?

Current Value Delivered: What have you provided in six months?

Risks or Watchouts: What could go wrong? (Hint: vendor evaluation or schedule conflicts.)

Next Steps: What should happen after the QBR?

Note: You do not need to complete every field exhaustively. Capture the most important information that would help you manage this account effectively.

Exercise 2: Outline a QBR Agenda

Step 3: Structure your QBR

Using the account plan you drafted, create a timed agenda for a 30–45-minute QBR with the following sections:

- Welcome and Purpose (set the tone)

- Review of Customer Objectives (reconnect to what matters)

- Progress and Success Metrics (show value delivered)

- Insights, Feedback, and Discussion (two-way conversation)

- Forward Priorities and Next Steps (reset for next quarter)

Step 4: Assign time blocks

Allocate approximate time to each section (for example, "Welcome and Purpose: 3 minutes"). Total should be 30-45 minutes.

Step 5: Include specific talking points

For each section, add 1-2 bullet points showing what you would actually discuss. This demonstrates that you are prepared with substance, not just structure.

Self-Assessment Checklist

By the end of this lab, you should have a completed account plan and QBR agenda that include:

- A partially completed account plan for TechStart Inc. with key sections filled in.

- A timed QBR agenda, 30–45 minutes, with specific talking points for each section.

- Account Plan: TechStart's business objectives captured in their language, not ProClean's features.

- Account Plan: Initiatives connected to scenario details such as Series B funding, hiring, and client demos.

Account Plan: At least three stakeholders with clear roles.

Account Plan: At least one risk or watchout based on the scenario.

QBR Agenda: A total time of 30–45 minutes with realistic allocations.

QBR Agenda: The most time focused on progress/metrics and forward priorities, not just the welcome.

QBR Agenda: Specific talking points included, not just section headers.

Strategic thinking is demonstrated through objectives in customer language, metrics tied to outcomes, and forward-looking next steps.

Summary

Congratulations! You have completed this lab by drafting an account plan and QBR agenda for TechStart Inc. In this lab, you practiced translating customer goals, stakeholders, risks, and success metrics into a value-driven account management plan. You also learned how to structure a QBR as a strategic customer conversation focused on progress, partnership, and next-quarter priorities.
